ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 2: **The Pot Maker; Quality; vocation poems** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** a gesture of trust that completes the passing of the craft	Trust allows growth.
2	**(a)** a market that rewards show over skill	Commercial values.
3	**(d)** He said that good boots last long.	A general truth keeps the present.
4	**(d)** it is held in trust for the community	Elders' view.
5	**(d)** the fragility of craft traditions	Both threaten the craft.
6	**(a)** flimsy	Flimsy is weak.
7	**(c)** unspoken and resolved through work	Resolution through pots.
8	**(b)** manual work built civilisation	Dignity.
9	**(a)** Honouring the Maker's Hand	Both honour craft.
10	**(a)** gave Sentila the confidence to trust her hands	She supported.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It protects Sentila from hardship (1) but denies her chosen path and the community's craft (1).	1+1
12	He shows ordinary neglect, not cruelty (1). The reader sees a shared social failure (1).	1+1
13	Customers who valued quality or fair pay for handwork (1). A balance of modest promotion with craft (1).	1+1
14	Nothing is said when the rows of pots are seen (1) so the meaning is felt without comment (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It protects culture and livelihood (1). It might limit individual freedom (1). A balance of sharing and choice is wise (1).	1+1+1
16	He shows small signs like thin hands (1). He avoids melodrama (1). The restraint makes the tragedy stronger (1).	1+1+1
17	It lets each worker express pride directly (1). It makes the workers seem real and equal (1). It honours work by letting workers speak for themselves (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Girls learn together under a supervisor (1). Pot making is shown as women's skilled work (1). The story values it as important heritage (1).	1+1+1
18	Cheap goods replace durable ones (1). Craftspeople lose work (1). The story urges conscious buying (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It honours by praising dignity (1). It may romanticise by ignoring hardship (1). The balance depends on the reader (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Pots as symbols of skill (1). Mother-daughter relationship (1). Community's duty (1). The passing on of values (1). The ending as renewal (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Introduction (1). Gessler's craft (1). Commercial pressures (1). Narrator's role (1). Conclusion with your view (1).	2+2+1
20	Skilled potter (1). Protective mother (1). Defensive before the council (1). Open to change (1). Realistic and loving (1).	2+2+1
	OR: First builds through a single arc to a hopeful end (1). Second narrates a long period and ends in loss (1). Different narrators (1). Different tones (1). Both lead to theme (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Mixing up the names: **Sentila** is the daughter who wants to learn pot making, **Arenla** is her skilled mother, and **Onula** is the kind older woman who guides her. Do not call the mother Onula.
- Saying Arenla refused out of dislike for her daughter. She wished to spare Sentila a tiring, poorly paid craft; the elders' view was that skills belong to the community and must be passed on.
- In 'Quality', saying Mr Gessler failed because his boots were poor. His business suffered because bigger firms advertised while he stayed faithful to **hand-made quality**; the story contrasts honest craft with commerce.

- Giving the meaning of 'vocation' as a holiday or hobby. It means an occupation one is suited to; link it to the **dignity of labour** in the poems.
- Spelling and usage slips: *skilful* (one 'l' in British spelling); 'spoke **to** Sentila', not 'spoke on'. Plural of boot is *boots*.
- Writing one story's facts under the other's title. Keep the two prose pieces separate: a village potter and a bootmaker, and mention a poem only when the question names it.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 2: **The Pot Maker; Quality; vocation poems** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** metaphor	Work is described as a gift.
2	**(a)** 'The Pot Maker' ends hopefully; 'Quality' ends in regret	Contrast.
3	**(b)** She treats skill as a private burden rather than shared heritage	Skill is shared heritage.
4	**(a)** g	Gifts, grace.
5	**(b)** a witness with a conscience	He narrates and regrets.
6	**(c)** values tradition while accepting a girl's right to choose her work	Balanced reading.
7	**(b)** undervalued labour	Labour not rewarded.
8	**(d)** handicraft	Machine vs hand.
9	**(c)** puts excellence before gain	Excellence.
10	**(d)** she feared poverty for her daughter	Reasons are inferred.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	His strength, devotion to quality, brings his fall (1). He cannot adapt to a changing market (1).	1+1
12	Community and mentors protect the craft in the first (1). Market pressure destroys the craftsman in the second (1).	1+1
13	She observes, advises gently and trusts (1). She does not take over, so Sentila's skill is her own (1).	1+1
14	Boots last for years so he sells fewer (1). His excellence reduces his income (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Silence and solitude create tension (1). Sentila's struggle makes the moment suspenseful (1). The rows of pots bring release (1).	1+1+1
16	Gessler's pride guards art (1). Arenla's concern guards her child (1). Both are valid, but concern allows change (1).	1+1+1
17	Respect for work is spiritual (1). Sentila and Gessler show devotion (1). The idea ennobles all work (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It builds independence (1). It avoids pressure (1). It requires prior preparation, which Onula gave (1).	1+1+1
18	If the narrator had valued Gessler, he would not have lost him (1). Third conditional marks regret (1). Verb forms had valued / would not have lost (1).	1+1+1
	OR: They show skill in every craft (1). They show the dignity of effort (1). They challenge the habit of ranking jobs (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Tradition needs people (1). Choice drives learning (1). Elders enforce sharing (1). Sentila chooses freely (1). Both are respected (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening and setting (1). Craftsperson introduced (1). Problem of neglect (1). Rediscovery (1). Ending with message (1).	2+2+1
20	Clay: raw potential (1). Pots in rows: continuity (1). The shed: space for growth (1). The tools: craft heritage (1). Together: tradition and renewal (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Examples from the unit (1). Reasons for respect (1). Call to action (1). Closing line (1).	2+2+1

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 2: **The Pot Maker; Quality; vocation poems** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** individual skill and lasting quality	Quality.
2	**(d)** he refused to cut corners even when business fell	Principle.
3	**(b)** the craft might fade from the family	Skill needs sharing.
4	**(d)** reinforce the idea of dignity	Repetition emphasises.
5	**(a)** dramatic irony or hindsight	Too late to help.
6	**(d)** Onula as mentor	Mentor.
7	**(c)** tribute	Tribute.
8	**(b)** society refused to pay for quality	Social criticism.
9	**(a)** If Gessler had advertised, he might have survived.	Had + might have.
10	**(b)** craft, tradition, dignity, mentor	Vocabulary.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	As excellence and respect for one's work (1) rather than wealth or fame (1).	1+1
12	Sentila inherits a craft, not just chores (1). The story honours her skill as valuable work (1).	1+1
13	They honour workers where society ignored Gessler (1). They offer the respect he did not get (1).	1+1
14	They survive if people teach, buy and respect them (1). Otherwise they fade like Gessler's shop (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Positive: it protects craft (1). Negative: it can pressure individuals (1). Overall the story sees it as positive (1).	1+1+1
16	Gessler made boots that lasted for years (1). 'That' links the clauses (1). It avoids repetition (1).	1+1+1
17	Name the craft (1). Say what threatens it (1). Say how people can help, as the stories suggest (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Sentila learns by watching (1). Gessler's skill came from long practice and eyes on leather (1). Observation leads to mastery (1).	1+1+1
18	Gessler's craft was ignored by customers (1). Object becomes subject (1). Verb becomes 'was ignored' (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Continuity means keeping something going over time (1). It is seen in the two rows of pots (1). Its absence is seen in Gessler's shop closing (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Honesty and skill are virtues (1). They keep him from advertising (1). The market punishes him (1). The narrator's neglect adds (1). The story criticises society (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The stories show individuals (1). The poems show a collective (1). They add celebration (1). They counter neglect with respect (1). Together they provide a whole message (1).	2+2+1
20	He first admires from afar (1). He keeps buying but forgets care (1). He learns of the decline (1). He feels guilt (1). He becomes the voice of conscience (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Sentila: patience and passion (1). Arenla: pride and care (1). Gessler: integrity (1). Each shows character in work (1). Craft shapes the self (1).	2+2+1

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